

Peakless vs bonkers.ie: the full comparison

Thirteen Irish households, every way in each site offers, scored against the true cost of every plan. Plus every feature, side by side. Run 5 October 2026.

MORE ACCURATE

Peakless

With a meter file Peakless picked the cheapest plan for all 12 smart-meter homes, within 0.5% on average. bonkers.ie picked it for 6 (11 if Energia's disputed price goes its way) and was 2.9% out on average, up to 21% on EV homes.

EASIER

Peakless, clearly with a file

A meter file is 3 taps to a full ranking on Peakless, 12 on bonkers.ie, which then shows only 15 plans and warns the file is incomplete when it is not. Typing: 11–19 short questions on Peakless against 13–14 on one long bonkers.ie form.

WIDER

bonkers.ie

Gas and dual fuel for every supplier, bill-photo upload, prepay, business, switching done for you, cashback, multi-year cost, and CRU accreditation. Peakless goes deeper on the home: solar, battery, car, payback, alerts.

How it was tested

Thirteen homes, each a full year of half-hourly meter readings in ESB Networks' download format: small, typical and large homes; two people working from home; a night-heavy home; a heat pump; night storage heaters; an EV charged on a 2–5am timer and one charged at teatime; 4 kWp solar with and without a 10 kWh battery; a rural home; and a home on an older 24-hour meter. They are built from ESB's published standard profiles, with heating, cars, panels and batteries added hour by hour.

The true cost of every plan over the next 12 months was then worked out exactly: each half hour at the supplier's published rate, announced price changes from their date, export paid at each plan's export rate, the urban or rural standing charge and the €6.67 PSO levy.

Each home went through both sites twice: typing its yearly kWh (and its export, car, heating and panels where the site asks), and uploading its meter file. 50 runs in all: 25 on bonkers.ie through its public form, one at a time, and 25 on Peakless.

Scored on two things: how far each site's yearly cost was from the truth, averaged over every plan it priced, and what following its number-one plan would cost against the truly cheapest plan.

Results, home by home

Each pair of columns is the average error on every plan the site priced, then the cost of following its top plan against the truly cheapest (€0 = it picked the cheapest).

Home	Truly cheapest plan	bonkers.ie, typed		Peakless, typed		bonkers.ie, file		Peakless, file	
		Error	Cost	Error	Cost	Error	Cost	Error	Cost
Small flat, 2,000 kWh	Waterpower Smart Tariff (SST) €867	3.3%	€4	0.1%	€0	0.4%	€0	0.4%	€0
Typical home, 4,200 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €1,509	3.7%	€33	0.1%	€0	0.5%	€27	0.5%	€0
Large family, 7,500 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €2,478	4.1%	€81	0.1%	€0	1.0%	€30	0.5%	€0
Two working from home, 5,100 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €1,776	4.5%	€77	0.9%	€0	0.7%	€28	0.6%	€0
Night-heavy (immersion on a night timer), 5,000 kWh	Electric Ireland Home Electric + SST Saver 16% €1,674	1.3%	€0	0.8%	€0	1.0%	€0	0.2%	€0
Heat pump, 9,000 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €2,817	3.5%	€38	5.0%	€38	1.0%	€31	0.2%	€0
Night storage heaters, 11,000 kWh	Electric Ireland Home Electric + SST Saver 16% €2,522	14.0%	€0	8.4%	€0	0.8%	€0	1.2%	€0
EV charged 2am-5am, 6,700 kWh	Flogas Smart EV Night Charge 29% €1,915	3.6%	€0	0.2%	€0	12.8%	€0	0.8%	€0
EV charged at teatime, 6,700 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €2,236	14.2%	€302	0.1%	€0	13.8%	€173	0.4%	€0
4 kWp solar, no battery exports 1,828 kWh	Electric Ireland Home Electric + SST Saver 16% €564	4.0%	€0	2.6%	€0	1.2%	€0	0.6%	€0
4 kWp solar + 10 kWh battery exports 840 kWh	Electric Ireland Home Electric + SST Saver 16% €491	3.2%	€0	12.5%	€147	0.7%	€0	0.4%	€0
Rural typical home, 4,200 kWh	Energia Smart 24 Hour €1,583	3.6%	€18	0.1%	€0	0.5%	€13	0.5%	€0
Typical home, older 24-hour meter	Energia Standard Electricity €1,578	1.8%	€10	0.0%	€0	–	–	–	–

The older 24-hour meter cannot produce a half-hourly file, so it has no file test.

Totals

	Average error	Picked the cheapest	Lost a year by following it, all homes
bonkers.ie, typed	5.0%	5 of 13	€563
Peakless, typed	2.4%	11 of 13	€185
bonkers.ie, file	2.9%	6 of 12	€302
Peakless, file	0.5%	12 of 12	€0

One disputed price moves bonkers.ie's score. Energia's own page today prices Smart 24 Hour at 28.10c, rising on 12 October; bonkers.ie prices it higher for the year. The true costs here follow Energia's page, which makes Energia Smart 24 Hour the cheapest plan for most ordinary homes. If Energia's new price turns out as bonkers.ie shows, Flogas Smart 24hr becomes the cheapest instead and bonkers.ie's file results improve to **11 of 12**: its only remaining miss is the teatime-charging EV home (€144 a year). Its typed results would be 6 of 13. Peakless's would drop by the same disputed margin (about €27 a year) on those homes. Either way, the ranking of the two sites does not change.

Where each one goes wrong

bonkers.ie

- **Typed usage assumes a night-heavy home.** bonkers.ie prices every smart-meter home on ESB's Nightsaver profile (37% of use at night). Ordinary homes use 23% at night, so night-rate plans look 3–11% cheaper than they are, and it recommends Electric Ireland's day/night plan to almost everyone. Fine for the night-heavy and storage homes; €33–81 a year wrong for typical, large and working-from-home homes.
- **"Optimise for EV" assumes overnight charging.** A car charged at teatime was steered onto an EV night plan: **€302 a year** more than the cheapest. Even with the meter file it recommended a night-rate plan for that home (€173).
- **Meter files from EV homes are misread.** With the file, EV plans were priced 13–14% too cheap on average (up to 26%). Every file was flagged "incomplete" and topped up with estimates, though each held a full year.
- **Only 15 plans after a file upload;** "show more" does not load the rest.
- **Storage heaters, typed: 14% average error** (up to 42%): one split for every home cannot fit a home with most of its use overnight.

Peakless

- **Heat pumps and storage heaters, typed: 5% and 8% out.** Peakless has its own shape for these homes, and so does this test; neither is measured, so this gap is uncertain. With the meter file both are within 0.2–1.2%.
- **Solar with a battery, typed: recommends an EV plan** (€147 a year off for this home) because it assumes the battery can top up from the grid at night. That is advice to change a setting, not an error in the sums, but the screen should say so plainly.
- **Everything else, typed or file: the cheapest plan, within 1%.**

What the test changed in Peakless

Found	Effect before the fix	Fixed
A solar owner's bill was read as if the home had no panels; the panels were then counted a second time.	A 4 kWp home with a €840 bill was priced as earning €97 a year. Recommendation wrong by €151.	The bill is matched against the home with its panels and export credit.
Adding a battery made the bill matching run away.	Usage pushed to 12,000 kWh; every figure wrong.	A search that always settles on the bill given.
Export in an uploaded meter file was ignored.	Solar homes 24–43% out with the file.	Export credited at each plan's rate: now 0.4–0.6%.
Every car was assumed to charge 2–5am.	Teatime charging home steered to an EV plan: €302 a year.	New question: "When does the car usually charge?"
(Earlier today) meter-file half hours an hour early; no night-use question; Night Boost standing charge; Ecopower missing.	See the first report.	Fixed.

The results tables above are after all of these fixes. Each has its own automated test.

Ease

	bonkers.ie	Peakless
Questions, typical home typed	13 on one long form	9, one at a time (usage, meter, area, supplier, plan, discount, heating, night use, solar/EV)
Questions, solar home	14 (adds export kWh)	16 (roof, slope, panels, battery, price, grant)
Questions, EV home	13 (one EV switch)	13 (mileage, car, charging time)
From meter file to ranking	12 taps, about 45 seconds of loading; then 15 plans, and an "incomplete data" warning	3 taps; every plan that suits the meter
Show the working	Line-by-line calculation per plan	Bill, hours, solar and accuracy tabs; a downloadable PDF report

Every feature, side by side

Feature	bonkers.ie	Peakless
Getting your usage in		
Typed yearly kWh / € spend	Yes / Yes	Yes / Yes
ESB smart-meter file	Yes (top 15 shown)	Yes (all plans)
Photo or PDF of a bill	Yes	No
National average if unsure	Yes	Yes (typical home)
About the home		
Urban / rural	Yes	Yes
Smart, 24-hour or Nightsaver meter	Yes	Yes
Heating type, night immersion	No	Yes
Electric car	One "optimise for EV" switch	Mileage, car, charging time
Solar panels	Export kWh only	Roof, slope, size: generation modelled hour by hour
Battery	No	Size and how it is used
Plans and prices		
Electricity plans	About 50 for a smart home	35 for a smart home (50 in all)

Gas and dual fuel	Every supplier	Five suppliers, for dual-fuel homes
Prepay, business	Yes	No
Dynamic (wholesale) plans	Filter	Opt in
Announced price rises	Included	Included from their date
Welcome credits, cashback	Cashback option	Welcome credits shown beside the yearly figure
Multi-year cost (2 or 3 years)	Yes	No
Export rate per plan	Used when export is given	Shown and used
Rates checked daily against suppliers' pages	Not stated	Yes, with the source on each plan
After the answer		
Switch for you	Yes, for partner plans	No: links to the supplier
Solar payback, quote check, SEAI grant	No	Yes
Price-rise and cheaper-plan alerts, contract-end reminder	Not on the comparison	Yes
Where the money goes, hour by hour	Per-plan calculation	Bill, hours, solar, car and accuracy tabs
Report to download, share card	No	PDF report, share card
Phone help	Yes	No
Regulator accreditation	CRU since 2012	No
How it is paid	Supplier commission on switches	No supplier payments

Limits

- **The homes are synthetic**, built from ESB's published profiles. The heat pump and storage-heater shapes, and the solar and battery behaviour, are this test's own assumptions, so typed-usage results for those homes are less certain than the rest.
- **The true cost uses each supplier's published prices as Peakless holds them**, checked today. Where the sites disagree (Energia's 12 October price; Ecopower, whose own page shows 2024 prices), the truth follows the supplier's page. The Energia effect is shown above.
- **Plans only one site lists are left out of the error figures**. bonkers.ie leaves out the current supplier's plans, so Pinergy (used as the current supplier) is missing from its results.
- **Gas, prepay and business were not tested**. Peakless does not compare them in the same way.

What would close the remaining gaps in Peakless

- Say plainly when a recommendation depends on letting the battery charge from the grid at night, and show the figure without it.
- Ask one question about when a heat pump or storage heaters run, or nudge those homes towards the meter file, where Peakless is already within 1%.
- Read a bill photo, as bonkers.ie does: the easiest way in for people without their meter file.
- Add prepay plans for prepay homes, and two- and three-year costs.

Run 5 October 2026. bonkers.ie was used through its public comparison form in a browser, one session at a time with pauses; its data API, which its robots file bars, was not used. Homes, true costs, scripts and every raw result are kept with the Peakless repository in docs/deep-2026-10-05.